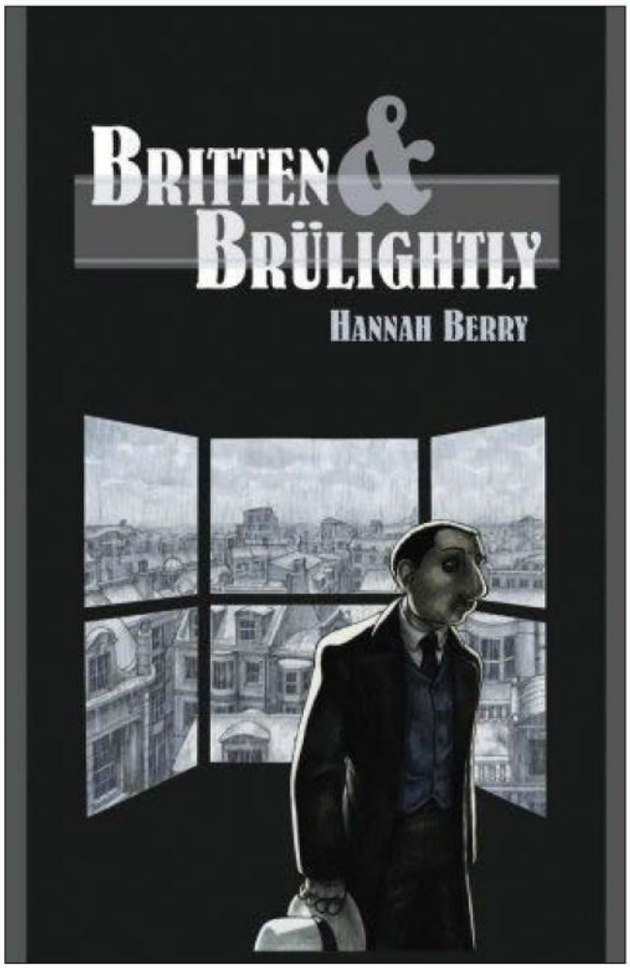
BRITTEN & BRÜLIGHTLY

Details **Originally published** Britten & Brülightly (2008) **Publisher** Jonathan Cape **Writer** Hannah Berry **Artist** Hannah Berry
Collected in Britten & Brülightly (£14.99) **Available digitally** N/A

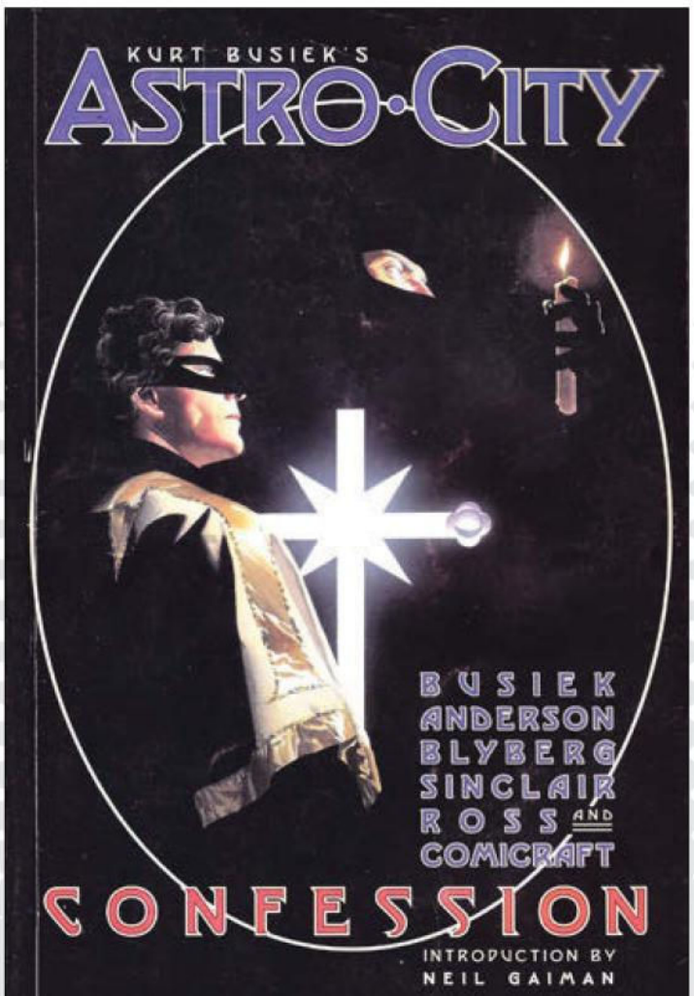


Private researcher Fernández Britten's years of uncovering people's secrets and confirming their darkest suspicions have left him teetering on the brink of a nervous breakdown. The one hope that keeps him going is the idea of redemption through delivering a truth with a positive rather than life-destroying impact. He's alone and ostracised – except for his partner, Stewart Brülightly.

This gorgeously murky noir, with a fantastic energy and wit, is truly like nothing else on the market. With touches of Douglas Adams and Raymond Chandler, the plot zings along as Britten takes on the case of a suspicious suicide where almost nothing at all is truly what it seems.



"Don't be lecherous. You're a teabag." Oh yes, and Brülightly is a sentient and rather horny teabag.



ASTRO CITY: CONFESSION

Details **Originally published** Astro City #4-9, #0.5 (1996-97, 1998) **Publisher** Homage Comics **Writer** Kurt Busiek
Artist Brent Anderson **Collected in** Astro City: Confession **Available digitally** N/A

Sometimes it's the small things that make a series memorable.

Astro City: Confession is on our list not for its main story arc, but for its inclusion of 'The Nearness Of You', a one-shot that explores memory, loss and love with a delicate poignancy not often seen in comics.

Of course, the main story arc ('Confession') is standout work, with an original approach to the old industry trope of superheroes being essentially immortal. 'The Nearness Of You', however, is a punch to the heart.

Busiek applies his interest in how superheroes' cosmic struggles affect people's everyday lives to ask a difficult question: when the realities of superhero continuities are rewritten, what happens to the realities of ordinary people, and do superheroes care?



Under the capes and battles, the story's themes are universal: how we remember those we've lost, our understanding of love, and the tenacity of the heart.